

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 22

LEVEL B • WORKSHEET

Worksheet: Why We Age

Reading Comprehension Tasks — based on the article on ageing, evolution, and metabolism

PART A — HEADING MATCHING [6 marks] Questions 27–32

Reading Passage 3 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**.

Choose the correct heading for paragraphs **B–G** from the list of headings below.

Write the correct number, *i–x*, in the box next to each paragraph.

List of Headings

i.	The biological clock
ii.	Why dying is beneficial
iii.	The ageing process of men and women
iv.	Prolonging your life
v.	Limitations of life span
vi.	Modes of development of different species
vii.	A stable life span despite improvements
viii.	Energy consumption
ix.	Fundamental differences in ageing of objects and organisms
x.	Repair of genetic material

Example: Paragraph A → **v**

27	Paragraph B Heading: _____
28	Paragraph C Heading: _____
29	Paragraph D Heading: _____

30	Paragraph E Heading: _____
31	Paragraph F Heading: _____
32	Paragraph G Heading: _____

PART B – NOTE COMPLETION [4 marks] Questions 33–36

Complete the notes below.

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in the boxes provided below the notes.

- Objects age in accordance with principles of **33** _____ and of **34** _____.
- Through mutations, organisms can **35** _____ better to the environment.
- **36** _____ would pose a serious problem for the theory of evolution.

33. _____	34. _____
35. _____	36. _____

PART C – YES / NO / NOT GIVEN [4 marks] Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the **views of the writer** in Reading Passage 3?

In the boxes below, write:

YES	<i>if the statement agrees with the views of the writer</i>
NO	<i>if the statement contradicts the views of the writer</i>
NOT GIVEN	<i>if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this</i>

37	The wear and tear theory applies to both artificial objects and biological systems. Answer: _____
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38 In principle, it is possible for a biological system to become older without ageing.

Answer: _____

39 Within seven years, about 90 per cent of a human body is replaced as new.

Answer: _____

40 Conserving energy may help to extend a human's life.

Answer: _____

PART D – VOCABULARY MATCHING [8 marks] Questions 41–48

Match each word or phrase (41–48) from the article to the correct definition (a–h).

41. wear and tear	a. the rate at which an organism converts food into energy	Answer: _____
42. thermodynamics	b. the ability to remain calm and untroubled; emotional steadiness	Answer: _____
43. dynamic equilibrium	c. a change in an organism's genetic material that may produce new characteristics	Answer: _____
44. mutation	d. gradual damage caused by continuous use over time	Answer: _____
45. metabolic rate	e. the branch of physics dealing with heat, energy, and their transformations	Answer: _____
46. hibernation	f. a stable state maintained by continuous opposing processes of equal force	Answer: _____
47. immortality	g. a state of deep sleep adopted by some animals to conserve energy in winter	Answer: _____
48. equable	h. the condition of living forever without dying	Answer: _____